Increase participation without putting students on the spot

Teaching

TEACHING ONE-PAGE PRACTICAL GUIDE

WHAT IS THIS FOR?

Create lower-risk ways to contribute so participation does not depend on speed, confidence or comfort speaking publicly.

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Create lower-risk ways to contribute so participation does not depend on speed, confidence or comfort speaking publicly.

WHAT DOES THIS LOOK LIKE?

Students have more than one legitimate way to contribute and are not required to perform confidence or disclose personal information to participate.

WHAT CAN I DO?

- Explain how participation will work before asking for it.
- Use think time before inviting responses.
- Offer different contribution routes where the activity allows.
- Avoid treating quietness or slower response as lack of understanding.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Students can respond through a shared document, small-group discussion or verbal contribution rather than one compulsory mode.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For the next teaching period, our team will: explain how participation will work before asking for it; use think time before inviting responses. We will review student feedback and adjust if needed.

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UQ teaching practices

Students as Partners

Inclusive practice